

Absolutely — **cake** is a strong polysemy/family target because your passage uses it here:

> “the shop sells handmade bread, pastries, **cakes**...”

Here **cakes** means **sweet baked foods, usually made from flour, sugar, eggs, and fat, often served for celebrations or dessert**. But **cake** also has several genuinely distinct modern meanings involving **small shaped masses of material, cosmetics/soap, compressed food, and the verb *cake* = become covered in a thick dry layer**.

Word family: **cake / caked**

Base word: cake

Plural: cakes

Verb forms: cake, cakes, caked, caking

Related adjective/participle: caked

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Meaning in your passage: **cake = sweet baked food — 蛋糕**

Your sentence:

> “Basically, the shop sells handmade bread, pastries, **cakes**...”

Here **cake** means:

> **a sweet baked food, usually made from flour, sugar, eggs, and fat, and often served in slices or for celebrations.**

繁體中文：

通常以麵粉、糖、雞蛋、油脂等材料烘焙而成的甜點；蛋糕

Natural translation:

> “The shop sells handmade bread, pastries, cakes...”

「這間店售賣手工麵包、酥點、**蛋糕**.....」

So here:

> **cake = 蛋糕**

1. **cake = sweet baked dessert — 蛋糕**

The core food meaning.

Practice 1 — Original

> “The shop sells handmade **cakes**.”

「這間店售賣手工**蛋糕**。」

Practice 2

> “She baked a chocolate **cake** for the party.”

「她為派對焗了一個朱古力**蛋糕**。」

Practice 3

> “Would you like a slice of cake?”

「你想吃一片**蛋糕**嗎？」

****cake = 通常以麵粉、糖、蛋等材料製成並烘焙的甜點****

2. ****cake = whole cake vs cake as food substance — 一個蛋糕 vs 蛋糕這類食物****

A useful countability distinction.

Countable:

> “She bought ****a cake****.”

「她買了一個****蛋糕****。」

Uncountable/general food:

> “Would you like some ****cake****?”

「你想吃一些****蛋糕****嗎？」

Practice 4

> “There are three cakes on the table.”

「桌上有三個****蛋糕****。」

Practice 5

> “I don’t eat much cake.”

「我不太吃**蛋糕**。」

cake can be countable or uncountable depending on whether we mean a whole item or the food generally.

3. **cake = small flat round mass of food — 餅；餅狀食品**

A major distinct food use.

Practice 6

> “She ordered a **fish cake**.”

「她點了一件**魚餅**。」

Practice 7

> “The meal came with two rice cakes.”

「這頓飯配了兩件**米餅**。」

cake = 壓成或製成小型圓 / 扁形的一塊食品

Common:

- * fish cake
- * rice cake
- * potato cake
- * crab cake

This does **not** mean sweet cake.

4. **fish cake = 魚餅**

Practice 8

> “The fish cakes were served with salad.”

「那些**魚餅**配沙律上桌。」

Practice 9

> “This fish cake contains herbs and onion.”

「這個**魚餅**含有香草和洋蔥。」

****fish cake = 把魚肉等材料混合並壓成餅狀後煮熟的食品****

5. ****rice cake = 米餅；年糕類食品****

Practice 10

> “She bought some ****rice cakes****.”

「她買了一些****米餅****。」

Practice 11

> “Rice cakes can be sweet or savoury.”

「****米餅 / 年糕類食品****可以是甜的，也可以是鹹的。」

****rice cake = 以米製成、壓成塊狀或餅狀的食品****

Exact Chinese depends on cuisine/context.

6. ****cake = compressed block/lump of material — 塊；餅狀物****

A broader physical noun meaning.

Practice 12

> “He bought a ****cake of soap****.”

「他買了一****塊肥皂****。」

Practice 13

> “The pigment came in small cakes.”

「那些顏料是以小**塊狀**形式出售的。」

****cake = 被壓成厚實、扁平或塊狀的一團物質****

This is a genuine non-food extension.

7. ****cake of soap = 一塊肥皂****

A traditional/common compound.

Practice 14

> “There was a fresh ****cake of soap**** by the sink.”

「洗手盆旁放著一****塊新肥皂****。」

Practice 15

> “She wrapped each cake of soap separately.”

「她把每一****塊肥皂****分開包裝。」

****cake of soap = 一整塊固體肥皂****

Some modern English more often says:

> bar of soap

but ****cake of soap**** remains established.

8. ****cake = compact mass of makeup/cosmetic material — 粉餅；塊狀化妝品****

A useful cosmetics meaning.

Practice 16

> “The powder comes in a compact ****cake****.”

「這種粉以壓實的****粉餅****形式出售。」

Practice 17

> “She applied colour from a small cake of makeup.”

「她從一小塊**塊狀化妝品**中取色上妝。」

cake = 被壓實成塊狀的粉末 / 化妝材料

Secondary but genuine.

9. **cake = verb, form a thick hard/dry layer — 結成厚層；凝結成塊**

A major verb sense.

Practice 18

> “Mud **caked** on his shoes.”

「泥巴在他的鞋上**結成厚厚一層**。」

Practice 19

> “The paint had caked around the edge of the container.”

「油漆在容器邊緣**乾結成塊**。」

cake — verb = 某種濕 / 粉狀物質在表面累積並變成厚、乾或硬的一層

10. **be caked with/in + substance = 被厚厚覆蓋；沾滿**

A very common construction.

Practice 20

> “His boots were **caked with mud**.”

「他的靴子**沾滿厚厚的泥巴**。」

Practice 21

> “The old frame was caked in dust.”

「舊畫框上**積滿了厚厚的灰塵**。」

****be caked with/in X = 表面被一層厚厚的 X 完全覆蓋****

Very common with:

- * mud
- * dirt
- * dust
- * makeup
- * blood

11. ****caked = dried/thickened into a hard layer — 結塊的；乾硬的****

Practice 22

> “The ****caked**** mud was difficult to remove.”

「那些****乾硬結塊的泥巴****很難清除。」

Practice 23

> “Caked powder had formed around the lid.”

「蓋子周圍形成了****結塊的粉末****。」

****caked = 已累積、乾結成厚層或硬塊的****

12. ****makeup caked on = 妝太厚 / 結塊****

A common beauty/contextual extension.

Practice 24

> “The makeup had ****caked**** around her eyes.”

「她眼周的妝已經****結塊****。」

Practice 25

> “Too much powder can cake on dry skin.”

「太多粉底可能會在乾燥皮膚上****卡粉 / 結塊****。」

****cake — cosmetics = 化妝品因太厚、太乾而積成明顯厚層 / 結塊****

13. ****piece of cake = 很容易的事****

A very common idiom worth flagging.

Practice 26

> “The test was a ****piece of cake****.”

「那個測驗****非常容易****。」

Practice 27

> “Once you understand the system, it’s a piece of cake.”

「一旦你明白那套系統，就會變得****很容易****。」

****a piece of cake = 非常容易完成的事****

This is idiomatic, not a separate literal meaning of bare ****cake****.

14. ****have your cake and eat it too = 兩者都想兼得****

Another high-value idiom.

Practice 28

> “You can’t ****have your cake and eat it too****.”

「你不能****魚與熊掌兼得****。」

Practice 29

> “He wants lower prices and higher profits, but he can’t have his cake and eat it too.”

「他既想價格降低又想利潤增加，但不能****兩者兼得****。」

****have your cake and eat it too = 想同時擁有兩個彼此衝突、無法兼得的好處****

Idiomatic layer only.

15. **take the cake = 最突出；最離譜 / 最厲害**

A secondary idiom.

Practice 30

> “I’ve heard many excuses, but that one **takes the cake**.”

「我聽過很多藉口，但那個真是**最離譜**。」

Practice 31

> “Of all the beautiful desserts, this one takes the cake.”

「在所有漂亮甜點中，這個真是**最出色**。」

take the cake = 在某方面勝過其他所有人 / 事物；可正面，也常帶諷刺

Important distinction: **cake vs bread**

You already curated **bread**.

cake

typically:

- * sweeter
- * richer
- * softer
- * often made from batter
- * eaten as dessert/celebration food

bread

typically:

- * more staple-like
- * bread dough
- * often yeast-fermented

> cake = 蛋糕

> bread = 麵包

But naming conventions can blur boundaries:

* banana bread

* tea cake

* fruitcake

So culinary names are not always scientifically neat.

Important distinction: **cake vs pastry**

You just curated **pastry**.

cake

usually made from batter and has a soft crumb.

pastry

usually based on dough rich in fat, often flaky/crumbly.

> sponge cake

> = 海綿蛋糕

> fruit tart

> = 水果撻 / 糕點

Not all sweet baked products are cakes.

Important distinction: **cake vs dessert**

cake

= a type of food.

dessert

= a course/category eaten after a meal.

Cake can be a dessert, but:

- * ice cream
- * fruit
- * pudding

can also be desserts.

So:

> cake $\subset$ possible desserts

Important distinction: **cake vs bun**

cake

typically sweet baked batter-based food.

bun

small individual bread item, often yeast-based.

> birthday cake

> = 生日蛋糕

> sweet bun

> = 甜麵包

Important distinction: **cake vs biscuit/cookie**

cake

soft and moist.

biscuit/cookie

usually smaller, firmer/crisper.

The exact boundaries vary by regional English and product style.

Important distinction: **cake — food vs shaped block**

Food:

> “She baked a cake.”

= 她焗了一個蛋糕。

Material block:

> “a cake of soap”

= 一塊肥皂。

Same word, different physical concept.

Important distinction: **cake — noun vs verb**

Noun:

> “The cake is fresh.”

= 蛋糕很新鮮。

Verb:

> “Mud caked on his shoes.”

= 泥巴厚厚地乾結在鞋上。

Completely different grammatical role and meaning.

Important distinction: **cake vs coat**

You curated **paint** and related coating ideas earlier.

coat

= cover something with a layer, often intentionally.

cake

= accumulate into a thick layer, often unintentionally.

> coat the chicken in flour

> = 在雞肉外裹一層麵粉

> mud caked on the shoes

> = 泥巴厚厚結在鞋上

Important distinction: **caked** vs **covered**

covered

very broad:

something is over the surface.

caked

more specific:

a thick, often dry/hard layer has accumulated.

> covered in dust

> = 佈滿灰塵

> caked in dust

> = 積了厚厚一層灰塵

Caked is much stronger.

Important distinction: **cake** vs **clump**

cake

verb:

material forms a broad/thick hardened layer or mass.

clump

= form discrete lumps/clusters.

> powder caked around the edge

> = 粉末在邊緣乾結成厚層

> powder clumped together

> = 粉末結成一團團

Important distinction: **cake vs loaf**

cake

one whole cake:

> a cake

loaf

one whole bread item:

> a loaf of bread

Both are countable whole baked items, but the nouns are not interchangeable.

Important distinction: **cake — countable vs uncountable**

Countable whole item:

> a cake

> = 一個蛋糕

Food/substance generally:

> some cake

> = 一些蛋糕

Different varieties:

> several cakes

> = 幾個蛋糕 / 幾款蛋糕

The context determines whether **cake** means:

* one whole cake

* some cake as food

* a type/design of cake

Important note on polysemy depth

****Cake**** has a compact but strong modern polysemy set.

The genuinely useful bare-word meanings are mainly:

1. ****sweet baked cake****
2. ****small flat food mass**** such as fish cake
3. ****compressed block/lump of material****
4. ****verb: form a thick dry/hard layer****

Then there are useful idioms:

- * piece of cake
- * have your cake and eat it too
- * take the cake

So we should not create separate lexical meanings for:

- * birthday cake
- * wedding cake
- * chocolate cake

because these are just different types of the same food sense.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern inventory includes:

- * ****cake — sweet baked food**** = 蛋糕
- * ****cake — countable whole item**** = 一個蛋糕
- * ****cake — food generally**** = 蛋糕這類食物
- * ****cake — flat food mass**** = 餅 / 餅狀食品
- * ****fish cake**** = 魚餅
- * ****rice cake**** = 米餅 / 年糕類食品
- * ****cake — compressed material**** = 壓成的塊 / 餅狀物
- * ****cake of soap**** = 一塊肥皂
- * ****cake — verb**** = 結成厚層 / 乾結成塊
- * ****caked with/in**** = 被厚厚覆蓋 / 沾滿
- * ****caked**** = 乾結 / 結塊的
- * ****piece of cake**** = 很容易的事
- * ****have your cake and eat it too**** = 兩者都想兼得
- * ****take the cake**** = 最突出 / 最離譜

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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cake — sweet food	以麵粉、糖、蛋、油脂等材料烘焙而成的甜點
cake — countable item	一個完整的蛋糕
cake — general food	作為食物種類 / 份量來說的蛋糕
cake — flat food mass	把食材混合、壓成扁平或圓形的一塊食品
cake — material block	被壓實、製成厚實塊狀的一團物質
cake — verb	濕 / 粉狀物質在表面累積並乾結成厚層或硬塊
caked with/in	表面被一層厚厚的泥、塵、化妝品等覆蓋
caked	已乾結、積成厚層或硬塊的
piece of cake	非常容易完成的事
have your cake and eat it too	想同時得到兩個彼此衝突、不能兼得的好處
take the cake	在某方面最突出；常可表示最出色或最離譜

For your original sentence

> “Basically, the shop sells handmade bread, pastries, ****cakes****, and simple drinks...”

The exact meaning is:

****cakes = Golden Crust 售賣的一個個甜味烘焙蛋糕，例如生日蛋糕或其他甜點蛋糕，而不是 fish cake、soap cake 或動詞 cake。****

Natural translation:

> ****「基本上，這間店售賣手工麵包、酥點、蛋糕，以及簡單飲品……」****

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > ****a cake**** → 一個蛋糕
- > ****some cake**** → 一些蛋糕
- > ****fish cake**** → 魚餅
- > ****rice cake**** → 米餅 / 年糕類食品
- > ****cake of soap**** → 一塊肥皂
- > ****mud cakes on shoes**** → 泥巴厚厚乾結在鞋上
- > ****caked with mud**** → 沾滿厚泥
- > ****piece of cake**** → 很容易的事
- > ****cake vs pastry**** → 蛋糕 vs 酥皮 / 糕點
- > ****cake vs bread**** → 蛋糕 vs 麵包